

067 Start a rock collection

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A rock collection is easy to start—rocks are all around you. First check out the rocks in your driveway, garden, or on beaches or riverbanks. Try to identify your favorites, then compare them with ones you find farther away.

What you need

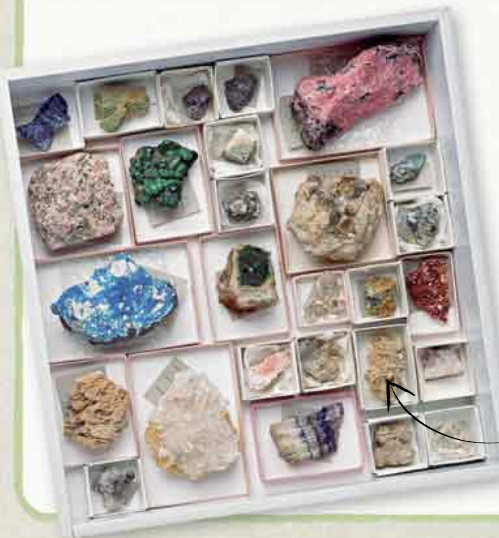
- A keen eye
- Field guide to rocks and minerals
- Magnifying glass



1 Divide your collected rocks into groups. Think about color, size, or where you collected them.



2 Use a magnifying glass to inspect your rock. Is it smooth or grainy? Does it contain crystals? Also look for layers, veins, bubbles, or cracks.



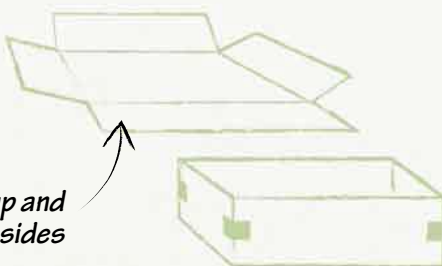
3 Make a display case or specimen tray for your best finds. As you identify them, add a label in each compartment so that you know what rock it is. You might choose to have a tray for crystals and another for green minerals, for instance.

Add labels to each of your specimens

068 Make a specimen tray

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Cut posterboard into a square. Cut small squares out of each corner to make side flaps. Fold up each flap and tape together. Cut out small boxes to tape inside as compartments.



Fold up and tape sides